Sol Date: 251020

To: Admiral Jo Stolp

From: Mission Director Kristine Poptanich

Subject: Alien Trait Compendium

Admiral Stolp,

Per your request, I scrubbed all mission reports to date for references to alien traits, and the results are attached.

Recommendation

Integrate the alien trait compendium into the cadet training regimen.

____X___ Agree _____ Disagree _____ Let's Discuss

Attachments:

Alien Trait Compendium

Alien Trait Compendium

Cadets,

Identifying aliens among us remains a critical skill for cadets and experienced explorers alike. While not all of these traits occur in every alien, they do represent the totality of our understanding of their unique idiosyncrasies.

Remain vigilant,

Kristine Poptanich

Mission Director

Some aliens . . .

- Avoid using contractions (e.g., can't → cannot).
- Only use short sentences.
- Do not use personal pronouns (e.g., I, you, we).
- Use formal or archaic words (e.g., Greetings, farewell, indeed)
- Rhyme when they speak
- Refer to themselves in the third person
- Always end sentences with questions
- Blink rapidly when speaking
- Will not answer personal questions about their age
- Refuse to speak about time
- Compare everything to the weather / speak about the weather a lot
- Speak about celestial objects (stars, planets, moons, etc.) regularly
- Overuse human interjections / discourse markers (e.g., Well . . .)
- Use and discuss numbers frequently
- Excessively compliment people during discussions
- Routinely use scientific-sounding phrasing (e.g., my data suggests . . .)
- Have unusual physical gestures / mannerisms
- Demonstrate fears about everyday human goods / experiences
- Misunderstand idioms (e.g., "Break a leg? That sounds painful.")
- Frequently mistranslate alien words into English
- Excessive note taking when people are speaking
- Give overly precise answers to questions

- Will not lie
- Uses repetitive introductory phrases to all sentences
- Excessive use of the words *yes* and *no*
- Touch their faces when speaking
- Show an unusual fascination with science and research
- Always try to redirect questions back at others
- Cannot describe or speak about emotions or feelings
- Will not talk about colors
- Uses words incorrectly and with regularity
- Use “we” in place of personal pronouns
- Speak primarily in metaphors
- Emanate strange sounds
- Look in odd directions when speaking / do not make eye contact
- Noticeably react to mentions of body parts, colors, or other odd topics.
- Overuse the future tense
- Avoid eye contact
- Are afraid of / amused by categories of things
- Are very interested in human characteristics